

Nagarjuna College of Information and Technology

Tribhuvan University

Institute of Science and Technology



E-governance in Srilanka

CASE STUDY REPORT

Submitted to:

Department of Computer Science and Information Technology

Nagarjuna College of Information and Technology

Submitted by:

Reman Khadgi

Roll no: 25

ABSTRACT

E-commerce in Sri Lanka has emerged as a vital driver of digital transformation, supported by the country's progress in e-Government and ICT-based community projects. Various government-led initiatives, including the e-Motor Revenue License system, digitization of birth, marriage, and death certificates, e-Human Resource Management, and the modernization of passport services, demonstrate how ICT has enhanced efficiency, accessibility, and transparency in public administration. These projects have not only simplified service delivery but also cultivated greater public trust in digital platforms.

In parallel, community-based projects such as the Kothamale Radio/Internet Project have bridged the digital divide by introducing rural populations to online knowledge and services. This initiative showcased how ICT can empower marginalized groups by creating opportunities for education, livelihood improvement, communication, and participation in local development.

Together, these experiences highlight the role of ICT as a foundation for the expansion of e-commerce in Sri Lanka. With increased awareness of digital benefits, improved access to online services, and a stronger culture of ICT adoption, Sri Lanka is gradually building a supportive environment for online trade and business. The case study underscores that e-commerce in Sri Lanka is not only an economic transformation but also a social one, reflecting the integration of technology into everyday life.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

I would like to express my sincere gratitude to all those who contributed to the successful completion of this case study on E-commerce in Sri Lanka.

First and foremost, I am thankful to my teachers and mentors for their valuable guidance, encouragement, and constructive feedback throughout the preparation of this report. Their support has been instrumental in shaping my understanding of the subject.

I also extend my appreciation to the authors and researchers whose works on e-Government and ICT initiatives in Sri Lanka provided the foundation for this study. Special reference is made to E-Governance by C.S.R. Prabhu, which offered significant insights into the digital transformation journey of Sri Lanka.

Finally, I am deeply grateful to my family and friends for their constant support, motivation, and encouragement during the course of this work.

1.1 Introduction

The rapid growth of Information and Communication Technology (ICT) has created new opportunities for countries to modernize governance, improve service delivery, and expand economic activities through digital platforms. Sri Lanka, like many developing nations, has recognized the potential of ICT in both public administration and commerce. Over the past two decades, the country has implemented several e-Government initiatives aimed at enhancing efficiency, transparency, and accessibility of services.

Projects such as the e-Motor Revenue License system, digitization of vital records, e-Human Resource Management system, and the modernization of passport services demonstrate how ICT integration has transformed public services in Sri Lanka. These initiatives have reduced delays, minimized bureaucratic inefficiencies, and provided citizens with convenient access to essential services.

In addition to government-led projects, community-based initiatives such as the Kothamale Community Radio/Internet Project have played a vital role in bridging the digital divide. By combining community radio with internet access, this project empowered rural populations with new knowledge, skills, and opportunities, showcasing how ICT can contribute to grassroots development.

These developments provide the foundation for the growth of e-commerce in Sri Lanka. With increased digital awareness, improved ICT infrastructure, and growing trust in online platforms, Sri Lanka is gradually building an environment where businesses can thrive through electronic trade. This case study examines the progress of e-commerce in Sri Lanka, highlighting its opportunities, challenges, and the broader socio-economic impact of digital transformation.

Some of the successful e-Government projects in Sri Lanka can be listed as follows.

- The e-Motor Revenue License project introduced in the Western Provincial Department of Motor Traffic (WPDMT) has enabled vehicle owners to renew the annual revenue license in a few minutes or obtain the license by making payments online. In formulating and implementing the e-Motor Revenue License project the WPDMT has collaborated with the Department of Motor Traffic and private sector service providers.
- The project on Digitization of Birth, Marriage and Death Certificates implemented by the Registrar General's Department has enabled residents to obtain a copy of any of the three certificates in a few minutes.
- The e-Human Resource Management project implemented by the Combined Services Division in the Ministry of Public Administration has led to a high degree of efficiency improvement, saving time and resources spent on administering annual transfers of public servants.

· The Department of Immigration and Emigration has adopted ICT successfully to improve efficiency and effectiveness of the Department. In the issue of passports to citizens and in border control activities at the international airport in Colombo the Department has been able to achieve efficiency improvements through ICT integration and training and motivation of staff

Kothamale Community Radio Internet Project

The Kothamale Radio/Internet project in Sri Lanka is an experiment in attempting to bridge the digital divide. The purpose of the Kothamale Radio/Internet project was to test and demonstrate an access model that reduce the digital divide/barriers and empower the marginalized communities in rural areas, by enabling them to enjoy benefits from ICT, to expand their knowledge base and thereby support their efforts to tackle the developmental problems themselves.

The project uses community radio as an interface between the rural community and internet through a pioneering "Radio Browsing" model. thereby introducing an indirect mass access to cyber space through a daily one-hour radio program on an interaction mode.

Example of radio/Internet Browsing

Following are some examples which describe the utility of Internet access at Kothamale community radio.

1. The village baker found various recipes from the internet to improve the quality of his products.
2. The village blacksmith browsed web sites to know more about modern implements for his trade.
3. An elderly woman visited a web site of Buddhist sacred places of India, and was very pleased as it was beyond her financial resources to visit the sacred place in persons.
4. Farmer accessed the internet to find information of improved techniques of tomato growing and storage.
5. A group of local products used the Internet and found export possibilities for "Jaggery," a local product of palm.
6. An English teacher of the local school often visited with his class and downloaded lessons and games for learning English.
7. Many community members opened e-mail accounts at the radio station and used the facility to exchange e-mail with their relatives working abroad.

8. A listener visited the site to find information on bamboo craft and organized an exhibition of improved bamboo products, which he produced with the new knowledge acquired from the Internet sources.

9. A group of you people used Internet sources and networked with an organization abroad to form an environment NGO. They then mobilized resources to launch a reforestation program in their community.

10. Radio provide location-specific weather report (for the coming four days) by reading real-time satellite picture and weather forecast data from Internet sites.

Benefits

Following are the noted benefits of this project:

1. An increased level of awareness concerning the benefits of ICTs.
2. New livelihood ideas and model projects
3. A high level of community participation and increased involvement of youth.
4. Enthusiasm of local political leadership and a resurgence of commitment to the communities they serve; more animated discussion about knowledge and expansion of the communities' knowledge base.

Conclusion

E-commerce in Sri Lanka is steadily developing, supported by the country's investments in Information and Communication Technology (ICT) and the success of various e-Government and community-based initiatives. Projects such as the e-Motor Revenue License system, digitization of vital records, e-Human Resource Management, and the modernization of passport services have proven that ICT can improve efficiency, transparency, and citizen satisfaction. At the community level, initiatives like the Kothamale Radio/Internet Project have demonstrated how access to digital resources can empower rural populations, create new livelihood opportunities, and enhance knowledge sharing.

These achievements have laid a strong foundation for the growth of e-commerce by increasing digital awareness, fostering trust in online services, and building a culture of ICT adoption. However, challenges such as limited infrastructure in rural areas, digital literacy gaps, and regulatory issues must still be addressed to ensure inclusive growth.

Overall, Sri Lanka's journey highlights that e-commerce is not only an economic transformation but also a social change. With continued investment in ICT infrastructure, supportive policies, and community participation, e-commerce has the potential to become a powerful driver of sustainable development in the country.

REFERENCES

1. Easy Explanation (2024). Computerization in Andhra Pradesh. Retrieved from <https://ezexplanation.com>
2. Slide Share (2024). Computerization in Andhra Pradesh. Retrieved from <https://www.slideshare.net>
3. APSTC Official Documentation.
4. NIC Andhra Pradesh State Unit Reports.
5. Secondary studies on e-governance in India's logistics sector.
6. E GOVERNANCE BY CSR PRABHU

